

Jose Morales-Arilla, PhD

Research Professor, Tecnológico de Monterrey's EGTP

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EDUCATION

Harvard University <i>PhD in Public Policy - Economics Track</i>	Cambridge, MA Sept. 2016 – May 2022
Harvard University <i>Master in Public Administration - International Development</i>	Cambridge, MA Sept. 2010 – May 2012
Universidad Católica Andrés Bello <i>“Licenciado” in Economics</i>	Caracas, Venezuela Sept. 2003 – March 2009

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS AND PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Tecnologico de Monterrey <i>Research Professor at the Graduate School of Government and Public Transformation</i>	June 2024 - Present Mexico City, Mexico
Tecnologico de Monterrey <i>Fellow at the Center for Trade Policy and Global Value Chains in North America (CEPCAN)</i>	April 2026 - Present Mexico City, Mexico
Texas A&M University <i>Assistant Professor at the Bush School of Government and Public Service</i>	Aug. 2023 – May 2024 College Station, TX
Princeton University <i>Postdoctoral Research Associate at the Department of Politics</i>	Aug. 2022 – Aug. 2023 Princeton, NJ
Harvard University <i>Postdoctoral Research Fellow at Harvard's Growth Lab</i>	June 2022 – Aug. 2023 Cambridge, MA
The Brookings Institution <i>Visiting Researcher at the Global Economy and Development Program</i>	Jan. 2021 – Jan. 2022 Washington, DC
Harvard University <i>Doctoral Fellow at Harvard's Growth Lab</i>	June 2020 – Aug. 2021 Cambridge, MA
Harvard University <i>Research Fellow at Harvard's Growth Lab</i>	Sept. 2013 – May 2016 Cambridge, MA

TEACHING

Tecnologico de Monterrey <i>Professor of EC2030: Econometría I</i>	Spring 2026
Tecnologico de Monterrey <i>Professor of EO502.5: Métodos Cuantitativos II</i>	Winter 2025
Tecnologico de Monterrey <i>Professor of RE4020.1: Economía del Desarrollo</i>	Spring 2024 - 2026
Texas A&M University <i>Professor of INTA670: Capstone Seminar on International Affairs</i>	Spring 2024
Texas A&M University <i>Professor of BUSH635: Quantitative Methods II</i>	Spring 2024
Texas A&M University <i>Professor of BUSH631: Quantitative Methods I</i>	Fall 2023
Universidad Católica Andrés Bello <i>Professor of Introduction to Causal Inference</i>	Spring 2022
Harvard University <i>Teaching Fellow for Big Data for Economic and Social Problems</i>	Spring 2020
Harvard University <i>Teaching Fellow for Advanced Quantitative Methods</i>	Fall 2019
Harvard University <i>Teaching Fellow for Development Policy Strategy</i>	Fall 2018
Universidad Católica Andrés Bello <i>Professor of Political Economy</i>	Fall 2012
Universidad Católica Andrés Bello <i>Lecturer of Macroeconomics</i>	2009 – 2010

PUBLISHED AND ACCEPTED PAPERS AND BOOKS

From collective punishment to constraints on authority: The impact of US sanctions on Venezuela Cambridge University Press	2026
Captured participatory institutions: Theory and evidence from the Consejos Comunales. American Journal of Political Science	2026
How to secure Venezuelan Democracy Journal of Democracy	2026
Escaping from hardship, searching for comfort: Climate matching in refugees' destination choices. Journal of Development Economics	2025
GLocal: A global development dataset of local administrative areas Scientific Data	2024
Opponent campaign visits in dominant party regimes Journal of Politics	2024
Transparent corruption: Connections, references and the demand for bureaucratic intermediaries Journal of Experimental Political Science	2024
Export side effects of wars on organized crime: The case of Mexico Journal of International Economics	2023
Gains from globalization and protectionism: AMLO v. NAFTA in the 2006 Mexican election Economics & Politics	2022

BOOK CHAPTERS, CONFERENCE PAPERS AND TEACHING CASE STUDIES

Defying the odds: Maria Corina Machado and Venezuela's 2024 Election HKS Teaching Case Study	2025
Economic Development in Historical Political Economy The Oxford Handbook of Historical Political Economy	2022
Is remote work in high demand? Evidence from job postings during COVID-19 COMPASS '21: ACM SIGCAS Conference on Computing and Sustainable Societies	2021
Improving Worker Safety in the Era of Machine Learning HBS Teaching Case Study	2017

R&R-STAGE PAPERS AND BOOKS

Vulnerability, fear of retaliation and clientelism: Organizer identity and the backfire of solidarity. Revise and Resubmit at American Journal of Political Science	2026
Direct flights, trade and specialization. Revise and Resubmit at Oxford Bulletin of Economics and Statistics	2026
Overcoming remoteness: How isolation affects economic development, and what can be done about it. Revise and Resubmit at Cambridge University Press	2026

SUBMITTED WORKING PAPERS

Proximity as a Substitute of Contract Enforcement in Specialized Trade	
The Urban Inequality Dataset: Measuring economic disparities within cities around the globe.	
Autocrats in crisis mode: Strategic favoritism during economic shocks.	
Welfare-Enhancing Sanction-Proofing Strategies: Theory and Evidence from Venezuela.	
Coalition trimming in spiraling economies: The case of Venezuela's Oil Czar.	
Effective threat, ineffective action: The narrow influence of the ICC on state killings in Venezuela.	
Information Asymmetries and Fraud Alternatives: Evidence from Venezuela's 2024 Election	
Industrial Matching in Refugees' Settlement Choices: Evidence from Venezuelans in Colombia.	
Economic Resilience of Migrants' Transit Routes: Evidence from Venezuela's Refugee Shock.	
Identifying Economic and Displacement Effects of US Sanctions: Evidence from Venezuela.	

ONGOING RESEARCH PROJECTS

- Favoritism during calamities:** Theory and global evidence from natural disasters.
- Defend the palace:** Autocratic favors towards and within capital cities.
- Elite redistribution as crisis management:** How rents were spread during Venezuela's collapse.
- Participatory institutions as usurpation devices:** The case of Venezuela's Consejos Comunales.
- Disappointment or alienation:** Individual preferences and behavior after voting on Hugo Chávez.
- Refugee shocks and the diffusion of organized crime:** Evidence from *Tren de Aragua* in Latam.
- Cross-generation Return Migration:** Evidence from Venezuela's refugee shock.

POLICY ANALYSES AND DATA VISUALIZATION TOOLS

- Productive development in Mexico:** New high-opportunity industries for the country, and where to develop them. CEPCAN, 2026
- Mexico Private Country Sector Diagnostic:** Sector assessment of the Mexican Autoparts Industry. IFC, 2026
- Predicción y pronóstico temprano de actividad económica:** Data satelital y administrativa para proyectar el crecimiento trimestral de El Salvador. ITESM, 2026
- Niveles de precios y distorsiones de mercado:** Determinantes del costo de vida en El Salvador. ITESM, 2025
- La Complejidad Económica de El Salvador:** Usando proximidades tecnológicas para identificar oportunidades de diversificación productiva ITESM, 2024
- Prosperity over conflict:** Leveraging economic interdependence for offshore energy developments in the Levant. Mosbacher, 2024
- Economic Integration of Venezuelan Immigrants in Colombia:** A Policy Roadmap. CGD, 2022
- Remote work wanted?** Analyzing online job postings during COVID-19. Brookings, 2021
- Impact of the 2017 sanctions on Venezuela:** Revisiting the evidence. Brookings, 2019
- Sanctions on Venezuela:** Cause or consequence of the crisis? Prodavinci, 2019
- Economic Complexity and Technological Relatedness:** Findings for American Cities. Brookings, 2019
- Growing Cities That Work for All:** A Capabilities Approach to Regional Competitiveness. Brookings, 2019
- There is a Future After Cars:** Economic growth analysis for Hermosillo. CID-Harvard, 2018
- Tabasco:** Reporte de Complejidad Económica. CID-Harvard, 2018
- Campeche:** Reporte de Complejidad Económica. CID-Harvard, 2018
- Baja California:** Reporte de Complejidad Económica. CID-Harvard, 2018
- Diversificación y desarrollo en Venezuela:** ¿Qué hacer si el petróleo ya no basta? Prodavinci, 2018
- Panama beyond the Canal:** Technological proximity and opportunities for diversification. CID-Harvard, 2017
- Economic Complexity in Panama:** Assessing opportunities for productive diversification. CID-Harvard, 2016
- Reforma económica de Venezuela:** Pobreza, Misiones y protección social. CID-Harvard, 2016
- Rethinking the Taboo:** Gasoline Subsidies in Venezuela. MPAID-Harvard, 2012
- Direct Distribution of Oil Revenues in Venezuela:** A Viable Alternative? CGD, 2012
- Data visualization tools:**
- GLocal Dataset, Metroverse, The Atlas of Economic Complexity, and Subnational Atlases of Economic Complexity for Mexico, Colombia and Peru. CID-Harvard, 2014-2024

AWARDS

Tecnológico de Monterrey <i>Most influential publication in the Faculty of Social Science</i>	2025
Tecnológico de Monterrey <i>Outstanding Professor Circle Award</i>	2024 – 2025
Mercatus Center <i>James Buchanan Fellowship</i>	2022 – 2023
Mercatus Center <i>Oskar Morgenstern Fellowship</i>	2020 – 2021
Mercatus Center <i>Adam Smith Fellowship</i>	2019 – 2020
Harvard University <i>HKS Distinction in Student Teaching</i>	2019
Harvard University <i>HKS Distinction in Student Teaching</i>	2018
Harvard University <i>PhD Program Financial Package Award</i>	2016
Harvard - MIT <i>Winner of the II Annual Energy Case Competition</i>	2012
Harvard Kennedy School <i>Frederick Fisher Memorial Prize for Second-Year Policy Analysis</i>	2012
Harvard Kennedy School <i>MPAID Honorable Mention for Second-Year Policy Analysis</i>	2012
Harvard Kennedy School <i>HIID Full Tuition Scholarship</i>	2010
Universidad Católica Andrés Bello <i>Integral Student Honor</i>	2008
Universidad Católica Andrés Bello <i>Member of UCAB's 10th Honors' Class</i>	2006 – 2007

CONFERENCE AND SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS

LACEA-LAMES Annual Meeting: “Welfare-enhancing sanction-proofing strategies”	Nov 2026
EGAP LatAm Regional Meeting: “Welfare-enhancing sanction-proofing strategies”	Oct 2026
CEPCAN's Conference: “Proximity as a Substitute of Contract Enforcement in Specialized Trade”	Oct 2026
REPAL Latam Political Economy Conference 2026: “Vulnerability, retaliation and clientelism”	June 2026
ITAM's Economic Research Seminar: “Welfare-enhancing sanction-proofing strategies”	April 2026
LACEA-LAMES Annual Meeting: “Vulnerability, fear of retaliation and clientelism”	Nov 2025
REPAL Latam Political Economy Conference 2025: “Captured Participatory Institutions”	June 2025
ITESM Forum: “Mexico as a Migration Origin, Destination and Transit Route”	March 2025
Southern Economic Association Conference: “Escaping from hardship, searching for comfort:”	Nov. 2024
LACEA-LAMES Annual Meeting: “Direct Flights, Trade and Specialization”	Nov. 2024
ITAM's Economic Research Seminar: “Escaping from hardship, searching for comfort:”	Sept. 2024
IDB's Governance and Development Seminar: “Vulnerability, fear of retaliation and clientelism”	Apr. 2024
Southern Economic Association Conference: “Transparent corruption”	Nov. 2023
Southern Economic Association Conference: “Vulnerability, fear of retaliation and clientelism”	Nov. 2023
NEUDC Conference at Yale University: “Autocrats in crisis mode”	Nov 2022
LACEA-LAMES Annual Meeting: “Autocrats in crisis mode”	Nov 2022
FDZ Rhur at RWI - Causal Inference with Spatial Data: “Autocrats in crisis mode”	May 2022
ACM COMPASS - Computing and Sustainable Societies: “Is remote work in high demand?”	June 2021
Pacific Conference for Development Economics (PacDev): “The economic victims of violence”	March 2021
Southern Economic Association Conference: “Gains from globalization and economic nationalism”	Nov. 2019
Southern Economic Association Conference: “The economic victims of violence”	Nov. 2019
Southern Economic Association Conference: “Solidarity against the machine”	Nov. 2019

SERVICE

Referee: Quarterly Journal of Economics, Journal of Political Economy, Journal of Economic Geography, Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization, Scientific Data, Review of World Economics, Growth & Change, World Politics, EPJ Data Science.

Seminar organizer: ITESM EGTP's Research Workshop, TAMU Bush School's Quantitative Research Workshop.

LEADERSHIP

Harvard University <i>Vice-President of the Harvard Venezuelan Student Association</i>	2020 – 2021
Harvard Kennedy School <i>President of the Venezuelan Caucus</i>	2010 – 2011
IESA-UCAB <i>Graduate of the 1st “Lidera” Youth Leadership Program</i>	2009 – 2010
Comunidad de Debate <i>NGO’s Founding President</i>	2007 – 2010
Universidad Católica Andrés Bello <i>Student Elected Representative</i>	2007 – 2008

MISCELLANEOUS

Nationalities: Venezuelan and Spanish.

Languages: Spanish, English and Portuguese.

Research Software: Stata, R, Python, LaTeX.

Opinion and Media: Published opinion pieces and Media Appearances for The New York Times, France24, CNN En Español, Project Syndicate, Faculti, The Journal of Democracy, Review of Democracy, Caracas Chronicles, Prodavinci, among other media outlets.

REFERENCES

Ricardo Hausmann - ricardo.hausmann@hks.harvard.edu

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